

THE
CONTAINMENTS



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**THE DOWNSTREAM EFFECTS
OF EXISTENTIAL FEAR ON
THE HUMAN SYSTEM**

(An excerpt from page 135 of Organic Psychology)

THE CONTAINMENTS
(V 1.2)

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INTRODUCTION

The first book I ever wrote (Organic Psychology) started off with a kind of creation story in a sense, and a relatively familiar one at that – Evolution. But it was also a story told from a very particular vantage point: It began with the nature and origins of organic structure in general, and only then led into the functioning of complex organic systems. And whilst that very early exploration was more of an exercise in thinking out loud about a subject that was far from entirely clear at that stage, it nevertheless laid the contextual foundations for what has now become known as 2EQ.

The crux of this emerging view is the existence of a sort of 'disease' in the way we have come to function, a complex and dynamic body of subversive dysfunction that lies perpetually submerged in the human unconscious, but which nevertheless causes an enormous amount of struggle and pain in life.

It is also true that much of the language used to explain this event back in those days has now been surpassed by graphic metaphors of various kinds (such as the 'octopus balloon' etc), and there is no doubt that my ability to put anything cohesive or legible on paper was also somewhat lacking back then. But it is also true that I have never attempted such a comprehensive exploration of both the context and content of this vast subject matter in a single sweeping stroke.

It was all there, even back then. I did actually capture it in my very first attempt, but apparently nobody could access it in that full and comprehensive style. Even today - after more than 15 books - I still find it amazing that people will ask me questions about things that were entirely answered in that original book.

And this is why this small section has been extracted, so as to be able to stand forward as being particularly important. It is because of all the things they ask about, the various forms that this event can adopt (the 'limbs' of this octopus) keep coming up as questions, perhaps because they are not really possible to explain without first of all laying down all the basic structural anatomy associated.

I mean, if I tell you that a wine glass will usually break either on the lip or at the stem, you can easily visualize these two variations. This is because you know what a wine glass basically looks like. And the same is true here, except perhaps that we are examining something a little more complex and dynamic in nature.

Therefore, this is what the entire sections preceding this part of Organic Psychology were explicitly devoted to. Nothing was covered there that was not entirely necessary for everything that would follow.

Obviously, this foundational priming is not something we will be able to do here, in that if I was going to provide you with everything you might need to understand this section then I

would end up completely rewriting the book from which this was plucked. So in that sense I ultimately have no option here but to refer you back to the broader context from which this small section was taken.

Which is to say: If you really want to grasp all of this fully, then you will need to do your homework. This little book does not stand alone. It is an excerpt only, and must be seen within the context within which it was written.

That context is as follows:

After explaining the origins and nature of the systems involved, and of the added disturbance, and before explaining the only clear solution to this hidden puzzle, **some of the various forms of this disturbance can briefly be outlined.**

What follows is therefore not a description of the tiger of existential fear itself, or its origins, or even what you might do to get rid of it, but merely an outline of a few of the various and common ways we can learn to live with it if we have no other choice.

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THE PRIMARY event being explained here is essentially geared toward the 'control' of what - on closer inspection - seems to be a perfectly reasonable process. After all it is natural for the organism's symbolic self-references (I, Me, etc..) to identify with the body, given that this is their purpose for existing. It is also a natural tendency of our 'change management systems'

to accurately formulate future outcomes, given – once again – that this is their purpose for existing, which must of course include the obvious reality of imminent death. In short, everything that goes together to produce the crisis we are explaining is natural and healthy functioning, all except the one thing that is never questioned – ‘I’.

We have already covered all the underlying context and structures that go together to allow this identity formation to have such a devastating impact on the way we function, so we won’t go over that again here. But we do now need to examine all the various downstream damage this emerging crisis can result in – including how incredibly dynamic and stable the resulting state can be.

So how does it work? How can the human system itself act to control or contain such an event, considering that it doesn’t even realise why it has occurred? There is no simple answer to this question precisely because the system doesn’t ever question the veracity of the ‘self’ it has manufactured, and also can’t easily or believably negate the reality of death, so in the end it simply has no choice but to

keep them apart somehow, both cognitively and at a feeling level.

The problems the system (we) then faces as a result are: Firstly, how to manage the creation of an integrated vision of the future without somehow putting the reality of death together? And, secondly, how to formulate healthy identity without somehow identifying with the body?

Neither of these options is very successful, if only because they are both entirely dysfunctional, and the resulting situation speaks for itself. There is simply no way to protect the system's integrity in the face of this dilemma because radical situations require radical solutions.

This leads us into the various forms this distortion might eventually take as our unconscious scrambles to put this emotional fire out. Every type or mechanism of containment this secondary agenda employs ultimately boils down to the same basic actions: Either the active negation of some felt sense of existential need, or the manufacture somehow of some sense of believable

existential fulfilment, or a combination of both. In simple terms this means to keep 'I' and 'death' – as felt realities – apart in every moment, forever.

Here are some obvious examples of the sort of tampering this very ambitious task might involve -

1 - Symbolic fulfilment structures.

Need at a physical level is represented in the formation of attachment at an emotional level. Therefore, as this crisis emerges in childhood it naturally displaces into the realm of the current attachment structures: Parents. The results are attachment bonds that become grossly overstated. This may happen suddenly (as in abusive environments) or more gradually (as in cloistered ones) but eventually the results are the same for all: The child's emotional needs eventually begin to go through the roof, and the capacity of parents to meet such thereby shrinks to almost nothing. Although it may often be the case that nothing serious has happened in actuality, the subjective experience of the child at this point

is that of severe emotional abandonment. Of course, as indicated above, any dysfunctional behaviour on the part of caregivers can obviously make this state far worse indeed, with even small actions then taking on great significance due to the degree of overstated attachment and crisis being faced by the child as they struggle to control their burgeoning fear.

It is perhaps because of this connection that much criticism has often been levelled at parents in the wake of how much trauma many people carry as they exit their childhood years, and in some cases this may have a degree of truth. But although dysfunctional parenting has a significant role here, it is not actually the main player – the underlying crisis is. This is perhaps why some children are able to survive tremendous hardship without it resulting in such trauma or damage. It could be that such resilience is due much more to what was *not* going on in their inner world, than to what *was* going on in their outer world.

Most people are not so lucky. Even in healthy and sheltered situations, for most people the result of this emerging crisis is an inflation of

natural attachment bonds to their primary caregivers, at least to begin with. To a child, the caregivers mean everything that is safe in life. They literally mean life itself. And although the caregivers eventually fail to fulfil the impossible emotional demands of the child, strengthening the primal attachment bond still helps the child to cope. It must also be stated here that if parents do succeed in providing enough security so as to either avoid this crisis arising in the first place, or in fulfilling its emotional demands, that they are probably feeding the child complete bullshit about life, and thereby not doing their primary job of preparing the child for the realities of life (we will address the damage caused by fairytales in a moment).

Overall, the results of this kind of 'interpersonal attachment inflation' are the formation of emotional structures that go well beyond representing the organism's actual relational needs. What we see is attachment founded in pure existential need, which the parents cannot ever fulfil, and which, sadly, the individual can do no better. And yet the primal nature of the infant bond to parents does still allow for a sort of trick to be played,

and for a degree of security to be felt, as long as the attachment is singular and massive in nature so as to stimulate the right emotional circuit in the 'baby brain'. All of which might seem relatively harmless I suppose, except that your parents are actually just ordinary people for the most part, who are themselves struggling with the very same issues. More importantly, what this does produce is a situation where infantile and regressive social traits remain active for much longer than is natural or normal, and even where this pattern can easily remain in place well into later life.

How it normally works is that your parents are like 'training wheels' that ideally assist you in learning to ride the 'bike of life', at which point they can be entirely discarded. But in this instance, it is as if the linkages that screw them on (emotional attachments) have been massively reinforced and welded on. So what this means is that when it comes time to begin transferring functional attachment (and the emotional energy such directs) over to yourself over time, the result is not a clean sweep.

Normally the assumption of full responsibility for the fulfilment of one's own needs would result in all interpersonal attachment being displaced from others, and back to fuel drives and functions within oneself. The transfer of such attachment bonds, and the responsibility associated, is what we call the transition into adulthood. Essentially, the energy and attention we once directed toward our parents (who met our needs entirely) eventually becomes redirected so as to fuel need fulfilment processes within ourselves instead. Beyond this point such bonds may remain and be cherished, but only in the sense that we may still love a trusty old horse that has been put out to pasture. They may still function as an emergency fallback option in a pinch, or for gentle fun rides for grandkids, but anything beyond that would smack of regression. Yet that is where so many still find themselves, if not directly (in relation to their actual parents) then certainly in relation to their emotional life being dominated by overblown interpersonal attachment and all the trouble that accompanies such. And this is because the massive attachment associated with this underlying crisis cannot be transferred so easily, for it can only be allocated to something

else that functions equally well to fulfil the needs associated – existential needs.

As indicated, parents never actually do this of course, but because of the nature of the primal attachment bond they can be used to provide such leverage ‘artificially’ in the emotive core. They can make you feel safe well beyond their capacity to actually save you. It is simply a loophole in the way we function.

Therefore, what we see here eventually confronts a bit of a tangle-up in the way that attachment is managed in our own system, so as to always maintain and ensure need fulfilment over time. Attachment represents emotional leverage. In particular it represents the amount of energy you will expend in order to protect your connection to the object of attachment. And the reason for this connection is always that the object in question represents a degree of need fulfilment. Therefore, attachment represents need fulfilment. It is quite simple. And so, with the eventual loss of any need fulfilment, if a new one cannot be found then the attachment must either remain in place or be re-integrated via the function of grief and formulated into an active desire. And

in the transition to adulthood, the shift is from dependency on someone else, to dependency on yourself. Your attachment (and all the energy associated) is unplugged like an 'umbilical cord' from whoever was suffering from such, and used as a 'power cord' to support and drive active need fulfilment processes in yourself. Interpersonal dependency thereby becomes intrapersonal empowerment. This is called growing up.

Unfortunately, the needs associated with this underlying crisis are simply too big to be integrated in this way. And what this means is that some of this attachment must either be left where it is, or be contained in some way, or be displaced somehow.

Remember: Not all of the crisis or its resulting stresses are managed via the mechanism we are discussing here. What we are talking about here is just one of many potential 'containers' for the overall management of the larger crisis. Overblown parental attachment is merely the first form to arise, and only helped lessen the fear by offering something 'safe' to which to cling. But for most people, as this infantile

pattern gradually fails, other systems have to come into play.

The result of this form of containment being displaced into other 'containers' (because of a lack of continued symbolic fulfilment) is that the potential always exists for it to be reactivated. Therefore, if an object of fulfilment becomes available somehow, containment elsewhere may well be displaced back to this pattern again so as to absorb as much of the overall crisis as possible, at the least cost. So overall this pattern is just one of the ways the human organism can share this load. In certain circumstances this mechanism will be busy and in others it will not, but anything that offers a degree of believable security will attract such attachment, along with the energy and attention associated. However, because the needs at the base of such attachment do not actually exist, each such fulfilment process is necessarily symbolic in nature - hence the name 'symbolic fulfilment structures'.

Such fulfilments can only make the organism 'feel' safe - they can never make it 'be' safe. For this reason, such attachment bonds are always prone to being unstable and fragile, to the point

where you might even conclude that they are outright doomed to fail from the very moment they are formed. All of which might sound unfortunate, but this is a very good thing when you consider that they are entirely dysfunctional by definition.

In this way we see the origins of many forms of adult attachment disorders, some of which are so common as to be considered normal, or perhaps even virtuous. Anything that functions to make us feel safer may attract such attention and its accompanying attachment.

As an aside perhaps, and just in order to help you see this pattern for yourself in real terms, we might take a moment to sketch just a few outlines as they commonly appear -

For the most part what we see in those where this distortion remains active is a situation where interpersonal concerns take an overly dominant role in life. For instance, it is a pattern where a person's 'self esteem' is far more determined by 'what others think of me' than by a person's actual ability to creatively and adaptively meet their own needs. And this

‘peer focus’ is not merely a remnant or the primal fixation the baby had with its caregiver, it is a direct and active extension of the very same fixation, which remains alive and well. Like a massive bit of baggage that the person has not yet learned to carry, that regressive fixation will generally be broken up and foisted onto any trolley that will accept it.

Continuing to seek approval from parents, either consciously or unconsciously, is clearly one tip of this submerged iceberg. A relative value system (rising to the expectations of society) is a symptom, as opposed to a more absolute values system (I have decided for myself what is right, good, enough.. etc). Strangely, both of these examples are often seen in the lives of so-called ‘high achievers’. In this same vain, a desperate search for attention and fame is also an obvious example of this same infantile pattern, in its widest and most scattered possible form.

These are all ‘other focused’ forms of existence; all variations of living form the ‘outside in’ rather than the ‘inside out’. They are also direct and immediate displacements of energy and attention that might otherwise be

deployed in the mode of self-reliance and personal empowerment. In other words, they all dramatically affect your basic creative ability - be that intellectual capacity, social innovation, or basic practical resourcefulness. They are regressive, even infantile, and to the degree they arise they always exist in direct opposition to the achievement of basic mastery in life.

When this pattern takes the form of another individual person, we call the positive symptoms 'romantic love', and the negative side effects 'co-dependence'. And we always want one without the other, but romantic love **is** co-dependence. It is merely a relationship that functions to stimulate the same kinds of 'lovey-blanket' security feeling as the parents once did, and into which such childish attachment may be re-awakened and transferred. Therefore, it can immediately take some of the overall load off other systems that may be struggling to maintain containment, and this will of course feel very good. The practical trouble here results from the attachment, not the feelings of ease and safety experienced. In this instance such attachment is simply massively surplus to the

requirements of good and aligned connection between adult people, and unavoidably produces strong unconscious expectations and demands.

Actually, it is lucky that this underlying transaction generally remains so unconscious, because we would never agree to its demands if they were all laid out on the table to see, or if we realised what we were being asked to fulfil as we signed that contract. For this reason, the human unconscious will only displace as much into primary relationships as it can get away with without causing too much trouble. This is why co-dependence can be very slippery to deal with. It can change day to day by the underlying attachment being displaced into other areas of life. It is not an isolated complex, but only one arm of a very mobile octopus.

In overall terms I often think of romantic love as being a 'Mummy' complex ('Mommy' if you are American). It is a regression to the primary attachment bond of mother and child, and only makes you feel safe by stimulating a primal circuit that once meant exactly that - existential security. So we frantically seek security in others, but then loathe the

suffocating psychological entrapment that results from the overstated attachment. Or we break free instead, and experience liberation from the burden of interpersonal attachment, but often feel miserable and empty somehow in the process. Essentially, and for as long as this pattern remains active in any way, relationships of all kinds become an unfair game that we just can't win. Paradoxically, the only people who will successfully carry such a heavy projection of personal responsibility are those who are perpetrating the same in return, in which case we see two 'half people' trying to become one 'whole one'. In which case it is important to realise that in forming any relationship what you get is $A \times B$, not $A + B$. So one half $\times$ one half = one quarter. Two half people do not make one whole one.

It is also the case that those who embody this pattern are easily infatuated by those who do not, if only because those who do not are significantly more actively creative and dynamic and socially fearless. But this is always an attraction that ends up poorly, in that anyone who legitimately represents freedom from this pattern will not even recognise the desperate approaches of those

who don't, because they are too busy looking off into the distance at the destination they are heading for, or putting energy into developing their ability to affect change. The only people on their radar will be those who are doing the same things - which for the emotionally dependent cripple are things they have never had much practice at. So this personal empowerment is a state people are often attracted to, but from a disempowered and dependent state they almost always fail to realise that it can only be experienced first hand, in person, and never via any deep emotional connection to someone else. If only because deep emotional connections to other people (in the attachment sense) are the very antithesis of what defines it. Those who are free of this attachment based dynamic are capable of depths of intimacy far beyond what the fearfully attached state would ever allow for, and therefore find the entire idea of such connections uninteresting, if not repulsive.

This is the puzzle of 'love' in the shadow of this simmering crisis. True love based on an alignment of complimentary energies that are moving in the same direction. But that entire potential is often completely overshadowed by

powerful unconscious drives that often briefly result in massive emotional releases of tension (experienced as ecstasy and levity), but which just as often cause failure (experienced as embarrassment, conflict, heartbreak etc). And what we don't generally realise is that these are two sides of the same thing. Unfortunately, Mummy couldn't save us, and neither can Fred, or Jane, or whomever we might find to take her place. In this mode, we are looking in the wrong place for an answer, and the results speak for themselves. In its compulsive form we might call this form of containment 'love addiction', or 'relationship addiction'. In any form, it is emotional dependency, and for this reason you will mostly find this particular form of containment pruned down to almost a stump in any typical (so called) 'balanced life'. At best, romantic love makes way for the emergence of aligned co-creation as both parties gradually grow up and begin to dance together in life. But if not, then this sort of stimulated fixation will die a natural death over time, and only ever emerge again briefly in the form of extra-marital affairs etc, if at all. Either way, eventually other forms of containment will need to be employed if

massive and increasing emotional crisis is to be averted.

So what about 'Daddy'? Didn't he make you feel safe too? Absolutely! From the perspective of the infant he was a towering giant, twenty five feet tall, and knowing everything (omniscient). He was a benevolent but sometimes stern source of all authority in the child's universe, which he entirely inhabited (omnipresent). And yes, he made the child feel safe. He was the source of all power (omnipotent). By relating to him, you knew who you were, and that you were OK.

So what happens when it comes time to let go of good old dad and realise that he was just another ordinary person like you? What happens to the existential attachments he can, as just an ordinary person, no longer carry? Who can assume such a mantle? Well, nobody can, obviously, except perhaps someone imaginary. But with enough subjective pressure anything is possible via the active corruption of belief formation.

Therefore, perhaps for the reason of fear alone, many people come to believe in God. And any

God will do, provided we can manage to believe there is some promise of salvation after death, and provided we don't have to do too much to secure our place there. Indeed, there are many versions of God as an idea, all of them like seeds that have evolved to grow in this particular soil of emotionally loaded human imagination and unconscious dread. Of course, we don't admit our motives openly, but are nevertheless pressed along by strong undercurrents in our unconscious.

Very often, in manufacturing this kind of symbolic fulfilment structure, we are basically seeking to redress some sense of paternal abandonment, in that the original emergence of this crisis did generally have the perceived effect of causing abandonment. Thus the imaginary recipient of this complex is usually some suspiciously human deity: A God in the form of a personality even, often seeming curiously akin to a 'great father'. How sad and childish it all seems when you look at it, but it does also indicate the degree of force we confront, which is apparently enough to maintain and support such open cognitive and social corruption. Unlike the 'mother complex' which stimulates infant states, this 'father

complex' is more akin to an immortality project. Rather than providing visceral warmth and stroking, this form makes you feel safe by more protracted means: By promising you fulfilment for existential need, as delivered in this instance by someone far more aloof. And the result is what could be called 'God addiction' in all its many spurious forms.

However, with the recent emergence of reason and mere common sense, the natural decline of God addiction has left a nasty void in cultural coping systems capable of supporting this kind of attachment based containment. Inevitably, as voids do, this void has been progressively filled by yet other forms of wishful thinking. Collectively such belief systems account for much of what has been called 'New Age' doctrines and beliefs: A complex body of very disintegrated views with little to unify them except for the one obvious tenet which runs through them all - which is that they are all emotionally attractive in some existential way. As such they too function to modulate how we see our situation so as to allay fear somehow. 'God is not going to save us, the Alien's are!' And if not that, then we will simply 'transcend'

the 'physical plane of existence' and leave the body behind!

We could go on...but I'm sure you get the picture. Sadly, almost all such culturally transmitted belief systems seem to more often reflect a need to believe, than any particular factual reality. Most are just unrecognised forms of social hysteria - just weeds that grew in soil left bare after the well-established God tree blew away in the wind of evidence and logic.

In the end, 'symbolic fulfilment structures' are just one form of systemic containment available for the underlying crisis in the human state. They represent just one way of managing existential fear. And hopefully they make some kind of sense to you, in forms you can easily recognise in yourself and in others. It should also be recognised that each of the examples given here is considered normal and acceptable in our culture, sometimes even desirable. But what if all of this has only been normalised in an effort to pacify people, in a purely blind and pragmatic sense? So think about this as we begin to discuss the possibility of removing the entire edifice later on, think

about what sort of world we might live in if society was not made up of individuals that were so fundamentally afraid, and so cognitively corrupted, or so emotionally weak.

God addiction, as just one example, is essentially a deeply cowardly path. Try to imagine a world without parasitic religions and the divisions they unavoidably produce, and without the tortures of emotionally dependent and intrinsically dysfunctional relationships of all kinds. And then consider that we have now only touched on one small corner of the entire event we will be addressing here.

Therefore, where is it? There it is, right under your nose, so big you can't even see it. But that's not all. That's just the beginning. One of the reasons it has all remained so incredibly concealed and undefined is that you simply wouldn't ever think to look for something **SO AMAZINGLY HUGE**.

We have only defined 'symbolic fulfilment' here as one isolated function, and whilst we will now continue on to do the same with the others we will now outline, it must always be remembered that in truth they all operate

together in a kind of integrated synthesis. The different forms of this overall complex dynamic merge endlessly into each other, overlapping, ebbing and flowing, in a kind of fluid tidal motion. Like objects hanging from a mobile, when one moves, all the others immediately compensate and keep overall balance. If this secondary agenda didn't create 95% of all the suffering in the world, I would even be tempted to say it was beautiful.

2 - Belief manipulation.

Another main body of potential containment is the active distortion or corruption of our own formulation of 'subjective reality', and the functions that manage such. You will recall that these are all the aspects of our 'emotional reality' that are actually the result of our own mental simulation and augmentation of aspects of actual reality that lie beyond the reach of direct perception.

It may be obvious already that the symbolic fulfilments addressed above involve at least some degree of this dysfunction, in that they rely on believing lots of obviously false stuff,

but this corruption also extends much further than that. The potential for belief corruption as a result of this underlying crisis is massive. What we just addressed as symbolic fulfilment structures are just the tip of the iceberg when it comes to screwing up such a delicate system – just a couple of the more obvious forms this might take. But actually there are many more ways to achieve the same basic end that also involve this same sort of distortion, and every element of belief formation is open to sway in some sense – in other words, open to silent and unnoticed corruption by this powerful unconscious agenda.

In particular, we see this sort of corruption emerging not only in terms of manufacturing some sense of imaginary ‘fulfilment’, but also in believably negating the felt sense of ‘need’. Just as we can manufacture some kind of future for the ‘I’, so we can also modulate the nature of this ‘I’ so as to make it less susceptible to threat. It is, after all, just an idea. We may not do this consciously mind you, but we can unconsciously and increasingly be presented with patterns of thinking that allow us to separate this sense of self from the source of death: The body.

Eventually, we might even manipulate the formation of belief systems so as to perpetually separate these two in our subjective experience of reality. We can come to believe and convince ourselves that we have a 'soul' for instance, some 'vehicle' in which our 'self' or supposed 'spirit' can continue to exist beyond death. And this works well to some degree because repression itself produces a kind of 'feeling-withdrawal' from the body itself, which aligns completely with the objectives of separating this 'I'. Essentially, the body is seen as the source of death, it becomes the enemy in some sense, and separation is then desired by the secondary agenda. Which is obviously both ironic and problematic given the actual truth of the situation, which is that this sense of self is merely and only one of the emergent functions of the body, and that separation of 'I' and body is therefore never actually possible. The ironic aspect of course being that this projected identity structure was intended to exist with the sole and only purpose to assist the organism (body) in achieving maximum success over time. The whole idea of a soul is akin to a wave trying to jump away from the water from which it is

made, yet once again – as an essential part of almost all salvation endeavours – we see this kind of idea promulgating through culture like an epidemic due to the gravity of the need and the amount of corruption we are prepared to live with if only we can feel a little better as a result.

Overall, belief manipulation is perhaps the most dramatic and unnoticed form or symptom of the human dilemma we are defining here. Silent, but extremely significant, it affects almost everything we do. It directly and unavoidably corrupts our cognitive development by enforcing deliberate hobbling of important functions. It produces emotionally loaded beliefs, assertions and ideologies that themselves produce individual struggle and even war. And this obviously affects the organism's relationship to actual reality, making any clear grasp of actual reality often seem like something of an uncomfortable imposition.

For the weaker minded, who are most susceptible to this form of containment (or for the culturally deprived, who grow up in a weak minded society) we see a general flight into

fantasy, and into the realm of subjective reality where we can control the outcomes and determine the rules. All the forms of symbolic fulfilment may in some way be classified as such. Essentially, we see the corruption of the aspects of our perceived experience that are being generated via mental probability and imagination, combined with a withdrawal away from any aspects of perceived reality that are actually real and which might obviously contradict our flight into fantasy.

Perhaps the most striking example of belief manipulation is the general negation of 'future awareness'. We have seen earlier how hard it is to come by, which means it is very easy for the secondary agenda to negate. Alongside this, what we also see is a narrowing of awareness onto a myopic bubble of local experience, with a deeply loaded aversion toward anything that might point to any greater whole or unified system of which our local experience is just a very small part. And in both cases we see the same basic thrust: A narrowing or limiting or shrinking of awareness, with a heavily defended boundary - a bit like the psychological equivalent of a gated compound. And here we can see that 'unawareness' may

become as powerful and damaging an addiction as any other.

In this context overall (in a legitimate negative crisis built out of healthy functioning) it can even be said that **positive thinking is dysfunctional**. Seeking to become comfortable with what is not supposed to be comfortable, is repression. As is seeking to turn a bad situation into a good one merely by calling it good, over and over again.

Although there can be dire consequences in relation to actual reality, almost all forms of containment involve or support this kind of belief manipulation in some significant way, perhaps because belief corruption is very easy to create. If we are prepared to close our eyes we can simply 'make reality up' to please ourselves, provided somebody takes care of our actual needs somehow. Of all the forms of containment, belief corruption is also very easy on the body. It essentially costs nothing except the sacrifice of cognitive integrity and a bit of 'self-brain-washing'. But at a relational level it obviously results in a bit of confusion when confronting actual reality and how to deal with it. Just as a Mickey Mouse watch will

not always tell very good time, a Mickey Mouse map may not take you where you want to go.

This form of corruption is clearly evident in the telling of fairytales to children by people who themselves suffered such abuse when growing up. And I'm not talking about stories, or myths, which may contain some element of life-valuable truth or morality. These are stories that embody such serious flaws in fundamental logic that they intentionally support dysfunctional neural development, which then creates alternate routes for the child's mind other than the natural and healthy paths that might inevitably lead to death and fear as realities to be faced and addressed appropriately. Thus, fairytales allay fear and help the child cope with their emerging existential crisis, but they only do so by corrupting healthy development. And they are almost always told by people who are still themselves suffering from delusions that depend on the same basic flaws in logic. All the forms of 'belief corruption' and 'symbolic fulfilment' as discussed above may be supported by the kinds of 'fallacy templates' created in this childhood corruption. In this light I suppose both God addiction, love

addiction, and new age fantasy could all be defined as kinds of ‘adult fairytales’ – all parts of the problem, none part of the answer.

In the simplest terms: The earlier and more powerfully children confront the reality of death, the better their chances of developing a strong and healthy mind will be.

3 – Core directive leveraging.

Without all the terms we outlined earlier in this book in relation to the various and necessary functions that together make up our own subjective anatomy some of these forms of distortion may not make a lot of sense. But another subjective function that receives a fair old hammering is the formulation of what we called our active ‘core directives’. These are all the various thoughts that function like mechanical parts, and which also act to set our standards.

If you imagine working on a computer as being a bit like using your brain in life, then these are like the aspects of all of that functioning that are more like the applications (unconscious

patterns) rather than the content (conscious thoughts). Some of these very deep patterns might even be broad enough to be thought of as something akin to the operating system you are running (MAC vs PC etc). The key point being that whilst these ideas recur effortlessly and can act like mechanical parts (hardware), but are actually the result of active thought processes (software).

In many instances these aspects of our thinking processes remain largely unconscious even when they are expressed in very specific forms. Yet it remains the case that in the perpetual attempts our own unconscious makes to unify and integrate these aspects of our thinking can produce certain summary ideas that are both extremely powerful as well as extremely simplified or even globalised. And of all the possible targets for repression or distortion that may potentially stand out for the sort of intentional damage we are outlining here, one of these unconscious yet very powerful abstractions stands out head and shoulders above the rest.

Whilst there may be many specific directives by which we define our emotive responses to

life, they can all be boiled down and viewed along one clear continuum -

I deserve <=====> I don't deserve

This basic core directive, this belief, this identity, functions to powerfully modulate your responses (and what you feel) in any situation.

Self-esteem as a concept is often maligned these days as a useful term in any serious therapeutic context, but this is largely due to being used in a positive sense as something to strive for, and for that it is pretty much useless. But the underlying reality is that we do indeed have a complex system of interlocking ideas that do determine our basic emotional responses to almost every event we confront, all of which can in many ways be viewed like some great equation that can indeed be boiled down to certain kind of ultimate sum. Therefore, your degree of 'deservability' (if there is no word for it, make one up!) might quite accurately be defined as one of the factors that together establish what is generally termed 'self esteem', even if we are viewing all of that from a slightly different angle here.

Many functional and energetic streams feed back through this simple idea, and its overall state determines many outcomes. It is a very big player. And whilst you might say that this core 'centre of gravity' does not necessarily represent a cohesive or singular assertion, in practice it actually does do this over time, and this is relatively easy to test in any situation. Whilst it may be true that we feel able to assert a high degree of expectation in relation to one area of life, whilst allowing other areas to languish, in general terms such divergence is resolved into a singular and universal level of expectation-demand.

This simple idea, because it is invested with so much emotive power, can make a huge difference to active emotional and psychological functioning if altered. And precisely because it is actually just a thought, but because it also has a big effect on our overall level of assertive response, this is often a great place for the unconscious agenda to apply leverage and thereby assist in helping to contain at least a bit of the overall functioning that has gone out of control.

You may be wondering what I mean here, or exactly how this works, so I'll explain this a bit more. Imagine a situation where needs are being deprived: A dysfunctional family upbringing, let's say. In that situation, if you internally asserted the idea 'I deserve to be treated with dignity and respect' you might experience much frustration or grief as a result of your situation. The contrast between what you **deserve** and what you **receive** would produce **emotional tension** geared toward change, precisely because this idea is a primary determiner of such response criteria. So in this case you might retain what might be called high self-esteem, but would also experience significant emotional stress. And this emotion would naturally spill out into action and expression in an effort to achieve the desired outcome, which in this instance might just be ordinary need fulfilment.

Such emotion has evolved to be expressed and produce change in this way. That is its purpose after all, and only as adults do we learn to control emotions so well. In many ways, this 'adult' faculty is exactly what we are talking about here, along with how much damage it can do if applied too heavily.

So what if, in the same dysfunctional situation, emotional expression was forbidden? What if, contrary to its purpose, emotional expression could get you thrashed to within an inch of your life, or produce even more deprivation? What can be done?

A child certainly cannot contain within them great amounts of active emotive tension without it being expressed in some way, leaving the only other option being to somehow 'turned it down', or even turn it off, and the easiest way to achieve this to simply alter your expectations of life. In other words: to change your degree of deservability.

So 'I deserve + I'm not receiving' = emotional crisis because it doesn't fit. But 'I **don't** deserve + I'm not receiving' = emotional equilibrium. No problemo.

This is a very easy emotional shift to achieve for a child, or for anyone in that it is a lowering of standards, but it has very serious and far-reaching consequences. It may help you get through a bad situation, but will also affect you well beyond it, if only because such directives

form a central part of the system's functional identity. They form part of the definition of 'who you are', and as such they transcend time, because 'self' as a construct is presumed to be consistent throughout time.

Therefore, the result of this kind of shift (to whatever degree it occurs) is a lowering of the essential personal standards, which from then on function to determine the conditions of life. And as the child grows up, what this means is that they will inevitably create their life to match these ideas. This is why we call this 'passive repression', it is because it is essentially invisible in specific terms and also very easy to generate.

All of which might lead anyone to say the following in relation to becoming aware of any damage in this area: 'they are just ideas, why not just change them?' But this is where the problem lies. Unfortunately, being so passive also makes it very difficult to move once it emerges. Like obesity, it represents a kind of luxurious debt that somehow has to be paid off, but the very weight of it can act to prevent any such movement.

Although they are just ideas, and can indeed be changed at will, they are also the determiners of much emotional process. And what this means is that because these ideas relate directly to self, any change made will immediately be post-dated into the future. Which is good, right? Yes, but it will also be backdated into the past. So 'If I deserve now, then I must have deserved then, and even though I let all that crap slide at the time, now I'm suddenly pissed off!'

In this way the lowering of these primary self-standards is an easy and enormous repository for the containment of healthy but unwanted emotional process, but also a deceptively costly path to take, in that if ever you are going to move these standards back then all that was avoided will need to be paid back in full. So to leverage them back to a healthy state is not as easy as it may sound, because it inevitably demands that we revisit many very loaded aspects of our own history. It means that the child within us will come banging on our door with many grievances to be addressed and brought to closure. We will have a debt to pay. And some of those can be very deep and serious, which is why many people never have

the courage to address such, or even the understanding of where it all comes from.

Anyway, I hope that makes a bit of sense. As it relates to the crisis we are discussing, we all experienced such a childhood in effect, and this is one way our systems can function to actively contain some of the ongoing results. If we don't expect to be happy, then what does it matter if we're not? So this kind of damage is like breaking the mast of our little boat in order to avoid the tension that the wind creates as our sail pulls on our rigging. It might be easy enough at the time, but also easy to regret that decision later, in that this lowering of our 'deservability standards' dramatically affects the way our life plays out in the long term. It becomes impossible to live a life of passion based on the fulfilment of a dream or vision because 'I am simply not worthy', 'I essentially don't deserve it'. And not only that, but if I do suddenly experience validation for the fact that perhaps I do indeed deserve it, then this shift will mysteriously cause me a great deal of emotional pain, and likely cause me to forcibly abandon whatever situation has recently supported this idea. Therefore, what we see here is one of the underlying factors

that has people continually recreating and maintaining the same kind of negative life circumstance over and over again, in an endless cycle of emotional entrapment.

The point is: Given the chance, the secondary agenda will drive these standards down as much as it can in order to take stress off other containments, thereby producing a strong and constant downward pressure on core self-esteem. And in transactional terms this affects almost everything we do. We all suffer from this to some extent, and this is where that mysterious force comes from. It is **NOT** a natural part of being human. Self-esteem, in the native human state, evolved under a constant pressure so as to be naturally buoyant.

4 - Deep process suspension.

We now move onto a far more direct and forceful method of controlling any emotional process that is getting out of hand. Unlike what we just addressed, this direct form is much harder on the body.

As discussed earlier, many subjective functions rely on basic physical realities for their integrity, and for this reason the higher executive levels evolved so as to always seek both depth of feeling, and quality of feeling – together. This is because at a physical level (the level these higher function are intended to serve) the maintenance of ideal states requires energy, and the result of having achieved this function is overflow – or ‘free energy’. Therefore, ‘free energy’ and ‘feeling good’ are the same thing, as viewed from two different angles. In this way the system has ensured that the maintenance of ideal states will always be achieved over time. It is like a system where the CEO of a company only gets paid out of the profit the company achieves, rather than the turnover – it ensures the CEO will remain very motivated to make sure everything is working in ideal terms at every point.

However, what this very same situation equally allows for is that almost any higher function may be thwarted if you are prepared to limit the flow of free energy within the system. Specifically, deep emotive processes (the maintenance functions of the emotive

core) may be frozen or suspended by either holding energy (feeling) in, or withholding energy (feeling) from, parts of the body. It means that if all you feel is 'very bad', then by affecting and sacrificing your own capacity to 'feel' freely at all, you can 'feel nothing' instead. And also that if you do that, then you will have basically lost the defining thread around which almost all of your internal integrity revolves. You will be able to go outside and stop the traffic, and it will remain stopped because no policeman will ever come to sort it out, because policemen only come if they are getting paid, and in this instance their pay (deep and positive feeling) will have all dried up.

Essentially, if the frontal conscious self is prepared to forfeit a degree of feeling, then integrity may be challenged and many processes stopped in mid flight. Like all forms of emotional repression what this involves is a functional limitation on energy, a functional limitation on feeling, and therefore a functional limitation on happiness.

And with this we come to one of the most fundamental and important things to understand about life and the human state:

That to not feel how unhappy you are, is not the same thing as being happy.

I will repeat that just to be sure –

To not feel how unhappy you are, is NOT the same thing as being happy.

This is because happiness is a state that at one level is explicitly defined by a depth of feeling, so to put ‘not feel’ and happiness together in any sense would obviously be to generate an oxymoron.

In this simple statement we can see almost every form of this disease laid bare, because almost every path it takes leads toward not feeling something bad, with the mistaken idea that this might lead to feeling something good.

So this indicates the HOW of deep process suspension, but not the WHAT of it. What are these deep processes that are being suspended? What exactly is the traffic that is being stopped?

In the simplest terms, the repression of a natural function is as easy as holding your

breath. It is certainly necessary sometimes, even though it is an interruption of a vital need fulfilment function. And just like all other repression, it always involves a slightly uncomfortable or awkward emotional element, in that holding your breath is a bit like swimming upstream in the river of natural tendency. But of course, that is not the main element of discomfort – the larger and ever increasing aspect is the resulting lack of oxygen and the effect that this has on your physical, emotional, and mental state.

Some needs, however, are not so desperate and immediate in nature. Some needs exist far more at the fringes of our ideal organic equilibrium, such as the need to be touched, or the need for sunlight. Nevertheless, even with those, if they are authentic needs then if they are withheld in some way you will always begin to show the signs of deprivation over time, and always with some resulting lack of quality of life.

The point here being that the repression of authentic need always has a cost at the outset, as well as an inevitable downstream cost as the function itself is not fulfilled. But what if the

need in question does not exist? What if the emotional system is flying out of control based solely on an illusion of need, rather than a reality of need?

In that case, the resulting state would obviously not suffer the same cumulative and toxic build-up due to deprivation, but if the emotional process itself was dramatic then the immediate costs of suppressing such active processes may still be quite steep.

The method of deep process suspension is very simple. To trap or contain a content you simply turn off the function that is processing it. Like cutting the stereo lead because you don't know how to change the music that is playing - it takes some effort, and it stops the music, but also makes the stereo useless. So in controlling negative feeling in this way, we also lose some of our capacity to simply feel in general, as well as distorting organic functioning so as to put it out of balance.

We lose a degree of vitality in this instance, as well as an unavoidable degree of natural physical wellbeing. Because energy is the primary currency of organic functioning, and

because deep process suspension always places distorted limitations on energy flow (feeling), there is always a physical cost to this kind of repression. With deep process suspension, the body suffers. All deep emotional repression is registered in the body somehow. Some forms of it are even very obvious if you are sensitive to what to look for. And you do look for it constantly. It is one of the things we continually scan for as we communicate with others at an unconscious level, which accounts for about 90% of all deep human communication.

What we see here is the opposite of what the emotional systems are generally charged with doing. Normally, what we see is the failure of a function, and the urgent need to replace it, as with a city when the garbage collectors go on strike. But in this instance what we see is emergency repression of healthy but misguided functioning, and this is also something the natural system can do. But it is always temporary in this form, if only because the needs in question are real and cannot simply be ignored for too long. Think of the rubbish piling up.

So this sort of thing would normally be a very temporary option. But what if you needed to intentionally suspend the garbage collection, because the drivers all came down with some contagious psychosis? What if the streets started filling up with hundreds of garbage trucks that were all driving around desperately looking for giant pink marshmallows, whilst ignoring the actual rubbish? If you were going to avoid perpetual conflict and strife, the easiest option in that case might be to simply pay them to stay at home, and then also pay to organise the rubbish collection via some other means. And these two costs are the reason this kind of repression involves high levels of energy to maintain, and why we are destroying the Earth in our mad scramble to regain some sort of emotional equilibrium.

We are now hopefully beginning to see that there are many forms of this potential containment, each with its own demands and costs. We will always carry it where we are strongest. The unconscious agenda will load up the structures it knows can take the punishment. And this one is once again a major

player in this game, and one with very obvious physical symptoms associated.

In this instance, apart from the very obvious organic dysfunction it results in as a necessary side effect, the intended result is pure emotional repression. But unlike any normal process of repression, there is no downstream build-up or thwarting of need, because the needs in question are not actually real (there are no giant pink marshmallows). And what this means is that the overall cost of this repression is not in the ongoing damage done to actual need fulfilment, but merely the costs associated with the repression itself, and of collecting the actual rubbish another way. Essentially, whilst repression is normally an emergency interruption of a need fulfilment function, in this instance it is as if the repression itself becomes a permanent need, and the costs of such become the demands and functions associated with that need. It is entirely backward in this sense, in that the very functions that are supposed to be serving the organism in various ways, end up directly attacking and subverting it in all manner of possible ways. It is as if the organism suddenly

discovers a permanent need to attack itself, and disrupt its own natural integrity.

At a relational or transactional level this often demands the maintenance of physiological imbalance through some combination of muscular armouring, postural distortion, high-energy diet, or low-energy lifestyle etc, just to name a few. And whilst the mid-organs are especially implicated in deep emotional processes (and therefore their suspension), the entire system is always pushed out of balance in some way or other as a result of this particular pattern. And this absolutely hammers the body. This is one form of containment that you can certainly die from, and many people do.

5 - Artificial stimulation.

In the wake of the sorts of imbalance we have just outlined the result is often a sense of bleak and arid emotional deadness - an emptiness somehow - a void. And this yearning can make attention restless and set it in search of restoration. All of which is entirely healthy of course, in that there is actually something

deeply wrong. But in this instance the very last thing we want is for attention to function naturally, because this might inevitably begin to restore order and integrity, and thereby reanimate this underlying crisis.

If all these various possibilities for 'dysfunction' are getting a bit confusing, then a very rough but effective analogy for bringing all of this together might be found in imagining the natural and normal processes of emotional equilibrium as being like a pack of dogs, and that in this instance the system has been forced to bury a big stinky bone that they found and became fixated on, to the point where they forgot all about what they were supposed to be doing.

In this instance what we then see is all manner of attempt to keep these 'dogs of attention' occupied or distracted somehow, rather than to continue to heap more dirt on top of the bone as they tend to dig away at it over time as seen above in deep process suspension.

Obviously there would be many options in that situation, depending on just how creative you want to get, in that it is a very dynamic

situation. The few that we will be outlining here will be only some of the main options.

Anyway, hopefully you can see how this particular form might work. What we look for in this situation is often some way to keep attention occupied elsewhere, distracted so to speak, so as to make that repression a bit easier to maintain over time. And there are several ways our own unconscious can do this.

First of all, we can keep attention busy perpetually, with all manner of stimulated distraction. We can keep the mind busy, always working, always mulling over something, and never just resting. And of course all of this frantic mental activity requires lots of energy if high degrees of muscular and organic tension are going to be avoided, and what this means is that we become very attracted to the kinds of stimulants that are not so good for the body, but very good for the maintenance of this sort of activity in the mind. Sugar, fat, caffeine, all manner of 'uppers', they all fit this role in some way, and thereby allow us to maintain this mental distraction without too much effort (yet still often at great organic cost).

Moment to moment, in any situation of available free energy (which should naturally feel blissful) the system is forced to actively distract attention from its natural tendencies which would begin processes of healing, and which would eventually re-animate the crisis as a result. This is like not being allowed to simply let those dogs rest, just in case they got a whiff of that buried bone and started to search for it as they naturally would. And the resulting state of unnatural agitation is what we generally call 'boredom'. And anything will do in that instance, anything to keep the mind occupied. Compulsive thinking, chronic creating (workaholism) the list is endless. This could be called 'distraction addiction'. It consumes energy in the form of stimulated or fixated attention.

Instead of 'pushing' attention, another way of doing this is to 'pull it' by providing direct mental and emotional distraction. This means anything that might absorb attention so as to provide some sort of escape from your own personal reality, and with this we see the rise of the entertainment industry, with movies, TV, the internet, and video games now embodying some of the largest economic

activities on the planet. We can only imagine what the advent of accessible artificial reality systems will result in, as people increasingly plug in and never unplug again. Which is not to say that any of these things are intrinsically negative in some way, it is just to say that they are all open to being employed by this underlying agenda as ways of managing the ongoing containment of this simmering emotional crisis.

6 - Self medication.

In many ways this form is actually the flipside of the coin we just covered, in that all forms of attention are actually just disturbances and consumptions of subjective energy that would otherwise be experienced as 'feeling'. As indicated earlier, free energy at a physical level is naturally experienced as emotional bliss at an emotional level, and it is this bliss that is disturbed and consumed in the process of attention and mental activity at the highest level by the conscious self. So instead of merely distracting or consuming this energy as it is produced, the other obvious target would be to

adjust the flow of energy, which essentially amounts to a limitation on 'feeling'.

All the forms of containment we have now outlined involve some kind of distortion of healthy function to be maintained, and all such distortion necessarily involves some manipulation of energy in the system, if only because feeling is the primary integrating thread. So in order to hold everything off balance, the secondary agenda must effectively prevent the healthy system from following its natural tendency toward free energy (and bliss) in order to maintain these balances and controls. And it must do this perpetually, in a very dynamic way. As already indicated, somehow it must function to run the business of organic existence on a zero bank balance, which is an incredible task. Too little energy and the organism will suffer ill health, but any to spare and it will go into a spiralling emotional crisis. So the system must use purge and release functions to control this emotional and energetic 'cashflow' as much as possible.

The control of free energy in an enclosed system can be achieved via only three basic principles -

You either limit its production, you discharge it as it emerges, or you pacify it in some way.

For the most part, the various forms of discharge generally take the form of distracting attention, as outlined above, in that thinking not only keeps those dogs occupied, but also consumes enormous amounts of physical energy.

Beyond this pattern of active distraction, there are many ways to put these dogs to sleep. Evolution has loaded certain mechanisms into the way we are made that can be stimulated so as to produce a disproportionate amount of tension release, if only because they relate to behaviours that always resulted in very positive outcomes within the context in which we evolved.

Sex is a discharge of psycho-emotive energy, and can be used to deplete the system of operating tensions. As can physical exercise of any form. Once again, bear in mind that every one of these transactions also has a natural and positive form. Almost any healthy

relational exchange can be subverted and used to this end.

At the other end of the scale we see the very deepest option in this regard, which is the control of free energy at its origin or root, by negatively impacting the organ systems into which the entire emotional system is anchored. What this means is that certain organ systems are pressed into a state of stress, normally as a result of overloading them with demand. Once again, this is a trick that works at an emotional level because the possibility of using too much consumption is not something evolution ever had a chance to prepare us for, and so there are no built-in safeguards. Yet the very deep tendencies toward valuing any form of high-energy food remain very present at a cellular level.

Therefore, another pacifying option is the consumption of certain types of food, in very specific combinations. Dehydrated food, heavy food, and very high-energy food all have the ability to trick certain brain systems into a state of tension release where they essentially lie down and go to sleep. Conversely, you might also discover that a bit of anaesthetic can

assist in putting those dogs to sleep for a while, and thereby lessen the need for such frantic distraction, in which case alcohol might become your poison of choice. Or dairy food of any kind, which if you think of it is simply so bizarre as a concept that it boggles the mind (try to imagine an ape sucking on the teat of a wildebeest?) - but because many mothers substitute the natural feeding of infants with food meant for baby cows, the infant brain becomes tuned so as to associated these foods with security and comfort in a way that be retained for life. It is no surprise perhaps that such children end up somewhat 'bovine' as adults.

These are just a few examples. The point is that all these foods and drinks are essentially employed as emotional sedatives in this sense.

At a more emotional level, we also see this artificial stimulation for a different reason entirely. In particular, what we see (as a result of our 'capacity to feel' being so limited) is a constant pressure not only to maintain the imbalances that produce this limitation (muscular tension, organic stress and toxicity etc) but also a constant pressure to want to

amplify the emotional sensation of what little feeling remains. And with this we once again see the introduction of stimulants of various kinds, along with all of the deleterious effects associated. We essentially see people trying to make up for depth of feeling with intensity of feeling instead, and this impulse can range from a tendency to reach for the chocolate bar as you walk around the Supermarket to an addiction to crystal meth or cocaine.

Mostly, what we see in this pattern is the overconsumption of types of food that by in large achieve both of these functions at the same time: They both produce and maintain critical levels of organic stress of organ systems that are heavily involved in the processing of emotion and feeling in general (and thereby limiting the depth of feeling), whilst at the same time providing massive amounts of high energy (so as to amplify the intensity of whatever feeling remains available).

Once you see how deeply the entire organic system is oriented around free energy as an ideal, it is easy to see how using high levels of energy might be a very effective way of

applying subversive force without too much resistance. Regardless of whatever form is applied, it is essentially a trick that our system will fall for every time.

It is maybe interesting to note that if you mix all these things up a bit, the resulting 'salad of stimulation' is pretty much a recipe for the average person's 'ultimate night out'. But we also see why a typical night out can take a week to recover from, not to mention how expensive it can be to pay for.

By contrast, in the natural human state the 'ultimate night out' would itself BE a process of recovery, and probably a very cheap one. As weird as it may sound, it is actually much more natural to crave perfectly steamed broccoli and a twilight swim at the beach than it is to crave milk chocolate, alcohol, and a movie.

7 - Physical-organic imbalance.

Due to all integrity in organic systems being so intrinsically linked to the management of free energy, and because free energy comes from healthy organic functioning at a physical level,

the distortion of these higher-level functions always ultimately has some effect on basic organic wellbeing. At the end of the day, the loss here is to physical and emotional integrity.

Put another way: Because every form of systemic repression involves a corruption of energetic integrity at some level, and because that integrity ultimately abides in the primary organism, every form of this secondary agenda negatively affects the body in some way.

Essentially, because primary organic functioning is the foundation of all higher integrity, if the system is prepared to sacrifice it at that level, then the maintenance of active dysfunction becomes easier. Like tying up the police, the raping and stealing can then be done in broad daylight.

This is where we finally see the integrity of the human system being corrupted. The entire need fulfilment systems of the organism (via the pressure applied to the frontal self) are operating counter to their primary directive – which is to ensure organic integrity and wellbeing over time. And what this means is that they are running directly counter to the

very purpose for which they exist in the first place. In certain respects, the frontal persona is forced to act in ways that literally attack the organism at the primary organic level. Which is obviously a clear violation of integrity: Like having your own arm for dinner. But in this instance following the demands of this extremely dynamic and complex added subversion is simply what 'feels good' to the conscious self, and it is generally yielded to without question.

The inevitable net result of these activities is ultimately damage to the primary integrity of the organism, which means this agenda represents a systemic conflict of the deepest order: A systematic, active and dynamic corruption of the system – of itself, by itself. It runs counter to the whole process of organic existence. It is a fundamental violation of the process that is life itself. What we see are systems that were developed over millions of years so as to **help** now actively seeking to **hinder** us in order to impose certain limitations on core functioning. Needless to say, this is probably why it feels bad.

In this sense, due to the physical level being so primary, it means that physical dysfunction is the deepest form of the dilemma. It is the very last line of defence for this reason, and used only very sparingly on most instances. But also – precisely because it has the ability to contain or negate so much emotional process – it also represents ‘large denomination notes’ in terms of ‘repression dollars’. If mental activity was ounces of repression, and emotional repression pounds, then physical imbalance would be repression by the ton. It is the principle impact point, and the heaviest load.

At this level what we see is obvious systemic imbalance, postural misalignment, organ stress, obesity, muscle tension etc, a whole barrage of possible points at which primary integrity can be affected. It is not a great leap to imagine how much disease could be directly attributed to this underlying event, for it requires very hard work to maintain such imbalance, as the primary organism is strongly self-regulating and self-balancing. The body is a self-healing system, so in order to overcome this tendency there must be continuous self-medication through diet, ingestion of stimulants, hyperactivity or laziness, a million

and one subtle relational exchanges all working together to keep things out of kilter. Such self-destructive behaviours often appear as compulsive and mysterious, with no other obvious value except that they make you feel better somehow. And if you resist them you often end up confronting an unconscious pressure with the power to overthrow your conscious will (in which case we see the foundations of the obsessive-compulsive cycle). Once it has done its work of maintaining an imbalance, a compulsion will naturally subside and allow your embarrassed (obsessive) will to regain control again - at least until the next time, which is generally just around the corner.

Summary

If we now come back to the ‘dogs of attention’ metaphor as a kind of round-up for all of this, we can begin to see all the various ways our own system might be pushed off balance so as to achieve this one vital function of concealing and controlling the potential of this underlying crisis.

At the risk of stretching the metaphor somewhat, you could do the following -

1. Throw the dogs a Kong (a rubber chew ball that you put a little bit of peanut butter inside) so as to keep them busy for hours without actually feeding them anything substantial.

= Symbolic fulfilment structures.

2. You could pull all their teeth out, and remove their claws.

= Belief manipulation, Cognitive damage

3. You could even breed a smaller or lazier dog that cannot dig very well.

= Core directive leveraging, passive repression, lowered self-esteem

4. You could bury the bone even deeper.

= Deep process suspension, emotional repression

5. You could actively distract the dogs by throwing a Frisbee.

= Artificial stimulation, perpetual distraction from feeling

6. You could slip them a sleeping pill in their food.

= Self medication

7. Ultimately, you could tie the dog up.

= Direct physical and energetic imbalance

So my hope is that you can at least begin to see that a great many of the patterns of behaviour that create negative states (internal) and relational circumstances (external) are not mysterious and enigmatic things. They are the fluctuating and dynamic foundations of something far greater. And if you try to remove them the result will generally be that another of this bunch will emerge to fill the gap and maintain the underlying containment, so if you continue to do that then you will inevitably

confront that deeper thing. And believe me, unless you know what you're up against you simply do not want to do that.

At the end of the day, the resulting common state is a very busy one. Even in paradise, there is little internal rest in this situation. No circumstance can fulfil these demands ultimately, if only because they are structurally conflicted with the natural flow. A need to interrupt a natural process of need fulfilment is a need that cannot ultimately be fulfilled, obviously. No matter what the frontal (conscious) self does, no matter what its achievements, or no matter what relational circumstances it acquires, it can never fulfil the emotional agenda it is given in this situation - not when compared to the native state. There is simply no ideal situation to be found because the game is ultimately not fair.

The end result of all this is the 'common state': A state of quiet discontentment with life, a subtle but profound sense that something is missing or not quite right. And it is a very dynamic and stable situation, which means that if you simply follow your natural emotional tendencies at any point then you will

generally only make matters worse. The very best you can hope for is to find the point of least tension between a state that is bad, and a state that is worse. There is no obvious exit point anywhere in the resulting landscape of possibilities, and not even a signpost to say which direction that might exit be. Indeed, the conscious self is not even aware that all of this has occurred – after all, this is the entire point of all of it. The whole aim is concealment, which means that not only is there a need to conceal what is being hidden, but that the entire process that is doing the hiding must also remain securely unconscious at every point.

So, in the end, this is what the frontal self is up against – the front end of a deeply rooted and dynamic body of negative functioning that simply cannot be resolved whilst the tiny and seemingly innocuous cause remains active and present. The conscious self is then up against a veritable army of unconscious functions working at odds with the native and healthy agenda, and it doesn't even know it. All of which paradoxically leads to a situation where anything a person confronts that is contrary to their particular dominant form of repression,

or even the event in general (such as this book), is responded to with an immediate and significant wave of either bewilderment, unconscious resistance, or even outright aggression. And this is the saddest part of all – the only remedy the unconscious mind had as a way of managing this explosive crisis has had the unfortunate downstream effect of very securely preventing the actual cure.

On the other side, the collective manifestations of this individual need for avoidance can be seen like poisonous weeds that grow wild in soil that would not otherwise exist. They allow this avoidance to be normalised and even enforced in the individual. In a bent world, bent people can almost appear straight.

People know they are deeply unhappy, but the surrounding environment does everything it can to allow them to think this is normal. The very last thing they want to hear is any message that might disrupt this fabricated illusion, and burst their perfect and shiny bubble of denial.

This is the common state, as reflected in common culture.

HIDDEN RIGHT IN FRONT OF US

AS YOU can probably see the resulting state is a very dynamic one with many downstream consequences that we have not covered here, and there are simply too many potential symptoms of this whole conflict to begin listing in surface behavioural terms. But as you begin to stand back from all this there are certain broader patterns that begin to emerge. And ultimately, in perhaps its simplest rendering, the entire thing breaks down into **three basic streams** in one sense.

The most obvious and almost universal is what could be defined as general 'energetic dysfunction'. In the simplest terms what this means is the distortion or interruption of natural functioning via manipulations of how energy is managed at many levels, which in turn impacts on physical systems in many ways. In terms of the actual functions being targeted in this situation, there are far too many and varied to be defined, as outlined above, but what we are now addressing is just the overall impact that all of this has on the organism as a whole. And in this sense what we see is essentially a kind of unconscious but relentless and implacable self-attack that is very difficult to overcome or consciously comprehend. This is finally registered in the body itself, as outlined above in the section: 'Physical-organic dysfunction'.

However, that is only half of the picture in one sense, and here we see the second of our main three emerging. It should also be clearly established here that organic wellbeing is not only a physical state as reflected in the organism itself, but that it has an equal and equivalent environmental aspect. Instead of our 'state', you might think of this external

context as being our 'situation', and this is also directly and unavoidably implicated here. The reason for this is because these two aspects of life flow into each other constantly, in a kind of balancing homeostasis.

Therefore, and as we saw in earlier chapters of this book, the overall wellbeing of any organism could be defined as its physical state / its relational circumstance: Its inner and outer resources combined. And in our modern world, what this essentially equates to is **health** and **money** respectively: Inner and outer energy. Which, as we know, can generally be converted into each other quite easily.

And what this means is that it is not only our physical state that might be the target of deeply irresistible unconscious manipulations, but also our situation. In particular, instead of just discharging or avoiding energy in an internal sense (feeling), you might also find patterns that very powerfully affect the management and avoidance of external energy (money).

Ultimately, whilst money in the modern sense represents organic work in transactional terms, in most cases more money does not do anything but amplify the situation we are defining here. This is almost certainly why – beyond a certain point of basic fulfilment – more money does not make you happier, as you might imagine it would. It is because it cannot resolve this underlying event in a positive direction. But it can certainly be employed by this event in a negative direction, and we see this often. This is why some people find themselves perpetually hovering around a \$0 bank balance – this is merely a reflection of the organism itself being run at a zero balance in terms of feeling. This is also the reason why having more money is something that needs to be gradually adjusted to if it is not going to produce massive emotional crisis. Without alternative forms of containment in place, external energy will almost immediately convert into internal energy and spark off a spiral of emotional release, with the result being emotional upheaval.

So here we see the outlines of the first two of our big three addictions emerging. In the natural human state, energy is depleted by

relational demands in the form of work and expenditure. Effort = demand and energy loss. This is obvious I suppose. This is how it is supposed to work. But because many forms of the secondary agenda effectively function to do exactly the same thing (eliminate free energy from the system) they are effectively creating loads on the system exactly equivalent to great amounts of physical work. It all produces a massive load cognitively, physically and emotionally. It is all a sympathetic nervous system response, which means continuous stress.

So what does this state feel like to frontal awareness, to the conscious self?

The common state is simply **hard work**, a continuous labour. It is very hard work for the body, and it can certainly wear you down.

The external relational demands of the secondary agenda are also very demanding, in that they often essentially either eliminate or cost money. The whole conflict has very clear effects on your overall outer circumstances of life, it can essentially determine your entire situation. After all, it is very difficult for this

unconscious secondary agenda to keep organic energy levels low if you have too much free time on your hands, and no external demands (eg if you have money) - whereas if you are constantly exhausted physically or mentally, then controlling the whole thing becomes easier. And this is why it very powerfully manipulates circumstances so as to always keep you busy, keep you thinking about things, and keep you occupied. There is seldom any rest in the common state.

Perhaps the main point of what we are now getting to here is that in the broadest and most obvious manifestations we are now addressing, these impacts may not immediately be recognised as significantly harmful due to being so extremely broad and commonplace. They are paradoxically not obvious at all, even though they are all around us.

So if you want to see how this whole thing is playing out in your own life, right now, you might want to glance in the direction of the two most obvious and unrecognised features of this conflict:

Poverty, and Fatigue.

However, not all coping mechanisms are energetic in the negative direction, and the overall imbalances can in many instances be used in a 'rob Peter to pay Paul' sense. Precisely because the system is oriented around energy being scarce, an overabundance of resources in certain areas can also paradoxically help to support the secondary agenda, as we saw in relation to the control of emotional states via the massive consumption of high energy food for instance.

In collective terms we can also see this same pattern emerging, as one element of society becomes corrupted by an overabundance of resources, whilst another much wider section suffers economic deprivation. And wherever we see this imbalance emerging we see the third main form of impact coming to the fore as the main form of distortion or damage.

If you can manage to disturb or distort this underlying 'crisis situation' not by seeking to contain the results of a lack of fulfilment for existential need, but rather by conjuring up some imaginary fulfilment for such, then the entire problem will appear to go away

emotionally, and will thereby require little in the way of energetic containment. In other words, it might certainly be possible to solve an imaginary problem with an imaginary solution, and thereby eliminate the whole thing in some sense. But what this involves, because the needs in question cannot actually be fulfilled, is the maintenance of beliefs which reality does not support, and that in turn involves the avoidance of reality, or at least the aspects of reality that are problematic to your fairytales retaining their 'salvation' power. Which ultimately still boils down to a degree of energetic disturbance, in that cognitive integrity will need to be suspended over time, which is not possible whilst functions that maintain that integrity remain active and healthy.

Overall, what we see is that another less costly form of containment is indeed possible in this situation, and that it can take many and various forms (we addressed these particular forms above in the sections 'belief manipulation' and 'symbolic fulfilment structures' etc). But we also see that these forms are not actually as free of cost as they may seem. It is just that the costs are displaced

and felt elsewhere in this instance, usually by someone else far away, or by the environment as a whole.

Ultimately, this form mostly places limitations on the other great integrating force within us:

Awareness.

So here we see the other end of energy imbalance: Too much energy. Power addiction.

Money, in this world, is power. And fairytales become easier to maintain if you can control your environment so as to support them. Which is perhaps why certain people and certain cultures focus so heavily on this form of containment (or all the forms that require high energy input to maintain). There is essentially no limit to the power the system's secondary agenda may potentially seek in its manic flight from fear. And with this we see the emergence of greed as a potent driver in the realm of commerce and in the development of society as a whole.

Therefore, these three factors register the final body-count in this war of imbalance. **Poverty,**

Fatigue and **Unawareness** are by far the most significant and prevalent and unrecognised addictions on the planet. Almost everywhere that you see poverty, fatigue or unawareness in modern life, you are actually looking at this secondary event at work - which is pretty much everywhere.

Overall, we see here a few of the main forms this secondary agenda can adopt, if only in 'core level' terms. And although we can often see particularly obvious examples of any of these, we rarely see just one form manifesting in isolation. Most people gradually develop a kind of balance between many or even all of these types or forms, it just depends on how many plates you are able to spin at once. And the ones we have seen here are just a few. There are infinite forms of this distortion when you examine all the possible elements of life experience this subversive activity can manipulate. Like the various ways you can smash a wine glass, the list is basically endless. Some people may find themselves regressing. In which case it essentially makes them feel good to 'be' a child at times. Or you may be attracted to a really big addiction - a twenty year, full time, attention draining, energy

depleting coping mechanism... one that also offers you a tacit sense of continuing beyond death... in which case you may find yourself driven not by the need to be a child, but to have a child.

Or you might become obese, or alcoholic, or religious...

Or a combination of all these things at once.

I suppose there is an important distinction to make here between the basic underlying functions we have been identifying, and the way any of these might ultimately manifest in terms of tendency or behaviour. I guess you might think of food as an analogy, with meat and veges and bread etc being akin to the sorts of various distortions that can be driven by this underlying event, which at the surface level can all be combined together to produce a sort of 'hamburger' pattern of behaviour.

Life in general, even without this added underlying distortion, is always expressed in this same way. The underlying dynamics of native need fulfilment processes almost always express themselves at the surface of actual life

in the form of complex clusters of various motives and exchanges that simultaneously address many levels at once. Need fulfilment (thinking, feeling, acting) is like a river into which many tributaries flow. So what we essentially see here is another entire river flowing into the original and natural one, polluting it so to speak. And with that we see the pollution of almost all the major aspects of life. Close personal relationships are an example of this kind of surface level cluster, and one that is particularly polluted by the addition of this distorting event at very many levels. Your relationship to money is another, or your vocation, your diet, or your basic physical lifestyle in general. If you got really desperate to consume enormous amounts of free energy and attention, I suppose you could even choose to write a book!

Generally in life, this unconscious agenda adopts a very sophisticated and dynamic balance of all potential containments, spread right throughout the system, and right throughout life. It is a complex and dynamic play between both agendas, and it is always moving and shifting. No particular form is inherently preferred by the secondary agenda.

The only real consideration is preventing that old bone from being dug up, and any combination will do. Meaning that many of the outer manifestations of it (at a relational level) often reflect several different forms of subjective containment. But we can sometimes also have one form predominating, depending on our circumstances and state at the time.

The final result is a powerful but slippery unconscious agenda that often appears somewhat chameleon in nature. All of which leaves life in the common state - life as we know it - as a complex situation that is always built upon these two separate emotional foundations at once.

For the most part people are not generally aware of their own covert motives, or even aware that massive elements of common human life are broadly quite pathological. And this was the point of explaining the three main forms above (poverty, fatigue, unawareness). This entire conflict is so grand in scale - and so widely spread over life - that it remains securely invisible to the untrained eye. The entire secondary agenda is never identified as problematic in common life because it is so

seamlessly interwoven with myriad healthy functions. It is, actually, never clearly differentiated at all. Not ever. As far as I am aware, this emerging paradigm is the very first example of capturing it fully and in a way that does not allow it to escape out some back door. Therefore, all historical attempts to isolate some particular element of life as being 'the root of human suffering' have always come up short of the mark. As Buddhists did with attachment, and Freud did with repression. And many have done with sex, and money, and greed....you name it. You may even have thought I just did that with the desire for children. But no single function or aspect of life can be isolated as being entirely positive or negative inherently. Every element of life may, at times, become influenced by this conflict and adopt a pathological form. The only real determiner of 'healthy' is the origin, ie which agenda is feeding a behaviour, and that may change from moment to moment.

So if you wish to define which aspects of life are dysfunctional, and which are not, it is really not so easy unless you have some means of lifting the lid and examining the inner workings of all this as we are beginning to do

here. Imbalance is the key to all this distortion, which generally means too much or too little, or at just the wrong time. It can be very hard to identify in behavioural terms, even though the overall effects remain obvious in terms of a frustrating inability to simply and deeply relax and just be happy whilst remaining basically aligned with the Earth and the deeper ecosystems.

In the end it is not what you do, but why you do it that counts: Not *what* you want, but *why* you want it - not *what* you believe, but *why* you believe it etc. Our own motives are so corrupt that almost everything becomes suspect, and this can be very difficult to assess in any objective way. It is so interwoven that nearly all actions embody some energy from both agendas at all times. This is why we need to go deeper, we need to wander upstream and catch this whole river before it merges with the original one, and then follow that poisoned river right back to its source. This is the only way to truly release ourselves from the impossibly perplexing and complex trap we have ended up being caught in.

It has only survived so long through its ability to remain hidden in plain sight, and through dividing us against each other as a result of the real culprit not being obvious. It has been like an invisible monkey that has been running around a party slapping people on the ass and bumping people's drinks over. But with this broad outline you pretty much have what you need in order to get together and back it into a corner, and grab it by the tail. And once we start doing that, especially together, its days of causing all this conflict and strife will certainly be numbered.

The definition of the containments above is merely a very rough map of what you will generally find if you do choose to embark on that journey together. This is why it needs to be broadly comprehensive. It is because without all the exits blocked, the core event could easily sneak out and you will miss it. The entire collective exploration will become distracted in that instance, as the subversive agenda itself tricks everyone into once again taking a detour away from the core event. It is very sneaky, and common culture has become awash with these phantom 'exit ramps' on the road to insight.

There, then, we have the basic outlines of what we are up against in life. When you stack these various containments on top of the outline we achieved earlier for the originating events that cause all this crisis, what we see is the origins and essential nature of what I believe to be the single greatest obstacle to human happiness and wellbeing by far. In particular, what we see there is something you don't normally see at all, because all of this is intrinsically hidden from view at every point.

And with that, we also immediately see the obvious pathway out of that trap, along with the courage that path unavoidably requires. We essentially need to go boldly toward the very thing that has so many people running in fear, and - with our hands on the collar of those dogs of attention - we need to dig up that old bone and have a good look at it. You need to go uphill, and against the flow of both individual tendency and cultural expectation. This is how it remains so incredibly stable in its current state. The very nature of this situation means that the more you simply do what you 'feel like doing', the more it wins. It thrives on fear and trepidation. But if you can go against this up to a certain point then the entire thing can begin to unravel. The only

reason nobody is doing this now is because they don't even know it is there, and the reason for this is because nobody ever went there to have a look. And only a few need to take that journey, this is also an important thing to understand. Most people are not ready for such an adventure into themselves. But a few is all it will take to make their way upstream and poke a hole in the great dyke that has diverted this poisoned river and merged it with our own native flow, and with that the entire thing will begun to unravel for everyone, everywhere.

TRUE NORTH

IT IS also very important to grasp one crucial concept here: There are no degrees of this event. It might be very easy for you to be reading this and imagining that you only have some very mild or only partial form of what is being explained here, or even that you do not embody any of this at all. That would be somewhat grandiose to say the least, if not outright hilarious. Alas, there is only one basic form of this dis-ease, and it is present (almost) universally in modern humanity. The reason

for this uniformity in scale is that the basic purpose of this event is to conceal a body of functioning that is essentially identical in every different person, and what this means is that it must always bring functional integrity down to a certain common level in order to do this. Therefore, and paradoxically, if you imagine you might be too smart or 'together' to be suffering from all this then you are even more out of luck, because the very nature of it means that the bigger you are, the harder you will need to fall. The entire thing is precisely defined in scale by the low level of functional integrity required to prevent one very obvious process from emerging again, so high integrity is actually a disadvantage in that case. It is basically a 'one size fits all' event, so if you happen to have a huge lump of genius sticking out, then this event will generally just come a long and chop it off in its mad rush for control of a volcanic emotional crisis. All of which is to say: If you have been sitting there thinking "that's not me", then all this means is that you likely have one of the forms in which unawareness has come to dominate.

However, the fact that the core event is universal in scale does not mean there are no degrees in terms of how well you might be able

to manage this situation. It is a very complex and dynamic state that can potentially be managed in an equally complex and dynamic manner, provided you have the resources.

In this sense we once again see the role of culture, in that it is possible for the collective to record and transmit patterns of functioning that individuals have learned, and thereby to offer a kind of detailed 'recipe' for ideal management of this state. And at the lowest end, what this might allow for is at least the successful containment of this crisis in a very robust way, but at the highest end it might even allow for the recover of certain degrees of functioning that might otherwise have been entirely destroyed by this event. And I suppose this might be seen as the most ideal outcome in some sense, which is also reflected in the ideals of common culture. The final complex synthesis offered by common culture as the 'most balanced lifestyle and personal state' is actually a delicate fusion of careful functional distortion and avoidance mixed with as much recovery and maintenance of healthy functioning as possible. It walks a very fine line between genius and madness, like a tiger tamer sticking his head in the tiger's mouth. It

is a demonstration of a certain sort of well-prepared and highly skilled freedom, but it will never be the simple and radical freedom we biologically expected (which would exist naturally if there was no tiger).

Therefore, it is not true that happiness is not possible in the common state. It is possible, at least in certain sophisticated and manipulated forms. It is even possible to maintain a degree of happiness over time, especially for those who have very little natural integrity in certain regards. After all, the purpose of this underlying event was not to diminish happiness. Quite the opposite, happiness was merely a casualty - an accidental bystander in a sense - and this underlying event actually does everything it can to keep it standing where possible. But if it has to choose between being alive, and being happy, it will most often choose the former over the latter.

More to the point, it is the way common culture has allowed this disturbed state to be normalised that creates the most trouble. What this ultimately means is that we might be left in a situation where we are entirely unaware that our state is not actually normal, or that

the ideals of common culture are dramatically distorted. We may not be aware of the impact these patterns of collective functioning are having on the Earth as a whole, if only because it is one of the functions of common culture to separate us from such things. In this way the collective state comes to reflect the individual state, in that the collective is also concealing certain important things from itself. In the collective sphere, the 'conscious level' is the media (the 'cultural level dogs of attention' that need to be distracted away from what is actually most important).

The result is that we think this is normal. We imagine that the way we live now is natural and inevitable, rather than being dramatically distorted and dysfunctional (not to mention entirely unsustainable). We are entirely unaware that the ideals we are striving for may actually be the most dysfunctional of all, in that they are actually highly sophisticated variations of a pattern of corruption that is fundamentally and unavoidably damaging. Even if we reach these common ideals we don't seem to notice that all we generally end up achieving is to displace all of this damage into some other part of the living systems we are

part of. All we end up doing in that case is hurting others rather than ourselves, or harming the planet as a whole. But we don't tend to see all of that because the walls of our gated compounds and filtered media streams act to prevent such.

Which is to say: The least costly forms of this containment are not actually without cost – they merely support a myopic lifestyle whilst displacing the cost into other areas of life. They create 'blind spots' and then fill those spaces with pain – usually not your own pain, but the pain that others are experiencing in that instance, because of you. And this pattern is not at all rare. We see entire societies on this planet that embody this flight into opulent self-gratification and self-serving ignorance. It remains an ever-present temptation for anyone who finds themselves in a position of freedom to use that power to support isolation and ignorance, rather than insight and awareness.

Yet some still people manage to fight all of this, and with this we see ground for hope. As indicated, the patterns of functioning we see may not only be geared toward keeping the

crisis down, but also toward the recovery of the good stuff where possible.

The one thing that all of the above outlines do not offer directly is perhaps the single most important thing of all if we are ever going to be able to securely exit this terrible emotional trap. What we see there are a few versions of negative tendencies and behaviours and emotional states that might manifest at times in this conflicted state, or the kinds of damage we might do to the planet as we seek to find any kind of stable respite from it. It explains why the typical individual generally ranges from being mildly discontent at best, to being a passive and morally myopic lump of over-consuming self-obsession at worst. And whilst it may be gratifying to finally have some kind of underlying validation for exactly why this might be the case, as well as how it essentially works, this does not necessarily chart a very reliable course out of this state. It explains the broken state, but not the ideal state that has been eroded away. It explains the negative, but not the positive that was lost.

Yet if you look carefully enough, all of the details we have now gleaned do actually offer

this positive information quite clearly – you only need to turn it all upside down in a sense, and look at it all from another direction again.

To use a metaphor, you might imagine that what we have been doing here is lining up all the thieves who have been stealing the blocks from our own pyramid of integrity, with the result being that we are left with big ugly mounds that are quite flat instead of rising to a beautiful high peak. Beyond this, we have seen how common culture has come to reflect this ubiquitous state by defining this lowered state as ‘normal humanity’, and thereby largely preventing anyone from seeking more. But in doing this we have actually defined a great deal in terms of what that original integrity might be, as well as what the functions that have been eroded might be geared toward achieving if there were left in their ideal state.

So what do we see there? What is the ‘peak’ of this pyramid of integrity and ideal functioning? What is it that we have lost? Or, put another way, what is it that we are actually looking to recover? After all, this is clearly a very important question if we ever want to move beyond merely knowing what went

wrong – to begin to put it all right again. This crucial and defining apex is precisely what common culture has removed from common awareness in its mad flight toward shallow and immediate emotional gratification.

That apex is actually pretty clearly defined here, and even more so in this emerging paradigm as a whole. If we do turn all of this damage upside down and put the whole system together again, what we see is a sort of grand synthesis that all converges on one singular function. And that function is:

Effective change management toward the fulfilment of need.

In particular, what we see is that this apex function occurs in direct alignment with the wider processes of life we are only a small but natural part of. And more importantly, what we see is that this process would and should result in fathomless and extremely reliable states of emotional fulfilment at almost every point in its cycle of operation. And this is going to seem just too bizarre to comprehend, to the point where you might imagine that it is fanciful and deluded, but it is also impossible to

conclude anything else based on the nature of the systems we have been exploring here.

At a subjective level what we see here is this:

Extremely robust, perpetual, and effortless bliss.

Essentially, what we see as the peak of a fully reconstructed pyramid is a process of profound and dynamic ‘creativity’ in the sense we addressed in section one of this book. We see awareness expanding without limit. We see the formulation of vast and highly accurate simulations of future potentials along with their associated actions in the present. We see the capacity to adopt paths that may involve significant yet always temporary tension in the present so as to achieve the highest outcome states associated (my definition of what ‘creative’ actually means). We see moral development based on this same principle, where those paths may not necessarily be deemed higher because of the personal gain associated, but because of the overall gain (not only to your fellow humans, but to the system as a whole, including other animals or ecosystems in general). We see cognition

developing freely so as to embrace both rational and trans-rational states, with a particular focus on awareness of complex systems and patterns of change. And on the basis of all of this, what we would see is social development emerging to reflect all of this individual integrity, so as to both reinforce and record any and all positive developments over time.

What all of this boils down to is that the peak of this pyramid of functioning, the great machine that has been pulled apart by this subversive activity, is actually a 'happiness generator'. Therefore, most of all what we would see is a world full of people who were naturally happy in a way we cannot even really imagine from within our current state of subjective entrapment. We would see a situation where what felt good would actually be good for you, and also good for the planet. We would also see broad philosophical alignment between people, and the falling away of all the emotionally loaded and spurious 'religious divergence' we see today.

All of which is important to see for several reasons. Firstly, it is important because

regardless of all the downward pressure we do actually see a few people reaching upward toward this pinnacle even now. There are people who manage to display remarkable degrees of creativity in this change management sense, and some who even manage to do that in the direction of moral action. We do see very high cognitive capacity at times, even though it is very often emerging due to the profound absence of some of these other factors, but not always. The fact remains is that we do see some people labouring away, stacking their blocks up, even as they are being torn apart again every night as they sleep by an army of unconscious processes. And sometimes they do succeed in recovering a degree of mastery again, in the true human sense. Of course this may often mean sacrificing a degree of happiness in this situation, in that the underlying conflict has not gone away in that case. But for many the recovery of these higher states still remains worth it.

These people are the emerging heroes here. Those who have fought against this storm of destruction are our principle hope now, in that they alone possess the courage and capacity

and insight required to unite and truly fight back – especially in the face of these patterns becoming available for the first time. And this is important because without this particular context you may not immediately recognise them. The tensions associated with very significant change management (both the cognitive labour as well as the emotional tension) are toxic in the extreme. They are exactly like holding your breath, as outlined above. And this is where everything indicated above begins to tie back in here: The containment mechanisms this underlying crisis has employed turn out to be the very same mechanisms we would otherwise use (and suffer from to a degree) if we were going to engage in serious creativity. These ‘tanks’ originally had another purpose entirely, but because they are now full to the brim in the form of all this added containment it means that the original use is no longer available. And this is why people are often somewhat crippled when it comes to producing significant change, or even in recovering the sorts of cognitive rigor to see that such is possible. They simply do not have the capacity to embody or embrace the tensions associated with the paths that such change might require, or even the

courage to look for such paths. They are essentially already too tense, too unhappy, or just too weak and broken down to even try.

And this is what you need to know about those who do have this ability: If they are indeed using these capacities, then they might easily come to appear just like a particularly damaged and screwed up individual. They may indeed be suffering from very significant stress in that instance, not to mention social isolation as a result of going against the very dysfunctional norms common culture dictates. Their genius may indeed be bordering on madness if they are doing this, in that the recovery of these higher functions will often not result in the kinds of blissful emotional states that would naturally accompany such if the underlying crisis had already been released. Until then, such higher development will probably only cause some degree of stress, even as it produces even more stress and tension so as to leverage change toward positive outcomes.

In particular, any one of these functions being brought back into its fully engaged and operating state will inevitably generate a need

to displace containment into some other area of the system overall, which will be experienced as somewhat stressful even if it is adapted to over time. But even more crucially, if several or even many of these functional capacities are ironed out and lifted up and connected together, then while the resulting jump in creative potency can be very dramatic indeed, so can the massive jump in subjective stress. In that instance the convergence of these functions (the emerging peak of the pyramid) creates a kind of integrated synthesis that is certainly much more than the sum of its parts in the creative sense. But this restored unity and power also means almost certain failure for the ongoing containment of the underlying crisis.

Needless to say, the intentional restoration of these aspects of your own functioning can be challenging, especially if you achieve more than one at a time. The point being: This sort of courage is the key here. The whole point is that going in the right direction will not feel right in the first instance. This is the very nature of this trap. But it is also true that this resistance will give way at some point if you persist, especially if you do that together, and beyond

that point there will be a release. Provided the original spark of crisis is identified and addressed then the entire edifice will suddenly fall away and collapse into nothing. And beyond that point the full recovery of creative capacity, along with the full experience of the results of such being experienced as feely blissful, will begin to occur without resistance or limitation.

This potential release point is something we will address in the next sections, but for now it is also worth considering just one other implication that becomes clear as this missing peak emerges out of the mist. And this is that the missing peak of our own integrity is also the same peak that all of life embodies, it is a unifying apex, a summary and universal axiom around which all of life pivots. And this has very deep philosophic implications, in that what it means is that (if the shift we are defining here is the state we have historically called 'awakening' or 'spiritual enlightenment') the very highest of all human potentials is only unique to us in the sense that we were the only ones who managed to 'lose it'. It unavoidably implies that all other animals - indeed the entire universe and existence as a whole - are

already there. And this will need to be addressed at some later stage, in that there are a great many depths to all the things that this possibility fundamentally explains and resolves.

For now, the important thing is to see that there is first of all a vast and complex system of subversive activity that is tearing down this peak as we continually strive to rebuild it, and also that we cannot let that process win without at least putting up a good fight. What we now see is the exact direction in which we need to be striving, as well as a clear blueprint for both what needs to be built as well as what we might expect to encounter as we do this. We have a definition here of true north, and with that we see the path out of this situation emerging at last. And if we do choose to fight, with all of this awareness emerging, then gradually we might find that the tables begin to turn for us. We might find that insight alone was the key we had been seeking, and that when applied in practice it offers us a kind of subjective 'Kung Fu' in our battle against all this confusion, and that instead of fighting what seems like an invisible army of slippery assailants, that we might begin to see it all as

plain as day – and with that, to begin to really make ground against it.

Most importantly, we see that we need to do that together, not alone. We need the power and insight that only unity can deliver, because only within that context can gradual validation of the paradigm spiral upwardly so as to increase both interest and further development. And of course such an endeavour is bound to encounter obvious resistance from both the average individual person and the collective as a whole, especially in this spiralling form, which is why there is perhaps some need to consider doing this in private (only amongst informed and consenting adults etc).

Of course, any such resistance to mere claims could itself be seen as rather suspicious in this instance, in that if there really was nothing to the claims then nothing would be found upon having a bit of a dig and taking a look. In which case the predictable claim that ‘there is nothing there’ could not really stand as an obstacle to exploration, but rather an invitation to openly explore without any implied sense of threat or danger. Yet this is not what we generally find, especially as such

exploration does indeed begin to unearth precisely the kinds of patterns we have outlined above. So this argument does pretty quickly begin to deconstruct any resistance. But there is actually no need to foist all of this awareness on the timid and sleeping masses, not when just a few can make that trek without all of that distraction and fuss to burden them.

As stable as our situation may seem, both individually and collectively, the underlying and hidden reality is that this entire crisis in every individual is actually entirely dependent on the same crisis remaining in place in all the people around them. And what this means is that they all stand like dominos, entirely stable in the sense that a domino cannot push itself over, but this also means they are only stable until the dominos around them begin to fall. Which in turn means that once the whole thing begins to unravel, we will all just be able to sit back and watch the show. Like a landslide, it will only happen once. The point of which is to say that the first domino is all we are talking about tipping over here. You will not need to repeat all the effort associated with reaching that point 7 billion times over. All the rest will take care of themselves, in that the resulting

wave of emancipation will simply be unstoppable.

Like making your way into an uncharted wilderness, it is a path that can only be walked once, and that only needs to be walked once. And that is not a path for everyone, but it is a pioneering path that at this point remains open to anyone with the courage to walk it. A great many will follow in time, not on these rough trails, but on highways named after those first few. It is only due to the incapacity of people to confront their own fears and overcome their own conditioned mental and emotional atrophy that we still remain trapped today, and it will only take a tiny minority to produce the small tear in this veil of denial and avoidance that will eventually 'rent the whole thing asunder', as they used to say.

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